

Cravitoo · Developer Interview Questions

47 questions to ask an outside software developer before you hire them — plus how to run the meeting and what red flags to walk away from.

How to use this document

Ask these questions in the order below. Their answers tell you if the developer is competent, trustworthy, and worth hiring — **before** you hand over a single credential.

- **Meeting 1 (~45 min):** Questions 1–15 + 40–47 → decide if you like them as a person and if their technical baseline is real.
 - **Meeting 2 (~30 min, only if Meeting 1 goes well):** Questions 16–39 + walk them through the app + hand over the Developer Handover Q&A and Bugs & Security Q&A PDFs.
 - **Then wait 24 hours.** Don't commit on the spot. Talk to references. If everything checks out, send the NDA + contract on Day 3.
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Section 1 — Background & credibility

Q1. How many years of full-stack experience do you have — split by frontend, backend, and mobile?

Q2. Show me 2–3 past projects with a live URL or Play Store link. *(No live link = red flag.)*

Q3. What was your specific role on those projects — solo builder, lead, or team member?

Q4. Can you give me two references from past clients I can call this week?

Q5. Are you a freelancer, a small agency, or moonlighting from a full-time job? *(Moonlighters ghost more often — plan for it.)*

Q6. Are you based in India? What's your time zone and typical working hours?

Q7. Have you worked on any food-tech, corporate SaaS, or multi-tenant apps before?

Section 2 — Technical fit (Cravitoo-specific)

Q8. How comfortable are you with FastAPI + MongoDB (Motor) + JWT auth? *(Ask them to describe how they'd add a rate-limiter to `/auth/login` — a 2-minute answer tells you everything.)*

Q9. How comfortable are you with React 19 + TailwindCSS + Shadcn?

Q10. Have you shipped a React Native app to the Play Store using EAS Build? How many?

Q11. Have you worked with Razorpay integration and webhook signature verification?

Q12. Do you know how to use Emergent's platform, or will you need me to walk you through Save-to-GitHub / Re-publish?

Q13. Have you set up GitHub Actions for CI/CD (running pytest + Playwright on PRs)?

Q14. Can you explain the difference between an access token and a refresh token in one minute? *(Basic auth literacy check.)*

Q15. What's your approach to writing tests — do you write them alongside the code, before, or after?

Section 3 — Security awareness

Q16. How would you rotate `JWT_SECRET` in production without logging everyone out?

Q17. Where do you usually store API keys during development? *(Correct answer: `.env` + password manager. Wrong: "in the code" or "in Slack".)*

Q18. Have you handled OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities before? Give me an example of one you fixed.

Q19. What's your first move if a client tells you their production database is compromised?

Q20. Do you use 2FA on all your work accounts?

Section 4 — Commercials

Q21. What's your hourly rate, retainer, or fixed-project rate?

Q22. Do you invoice with GST? *(Important for your books if they're in India.)*

Q23. What's your payment cycle — weekly, bi-weekly, monthly, milestone-based?

Q24. Do you require an advance? How much? *(50% advance is normal for small projects; 100% is a red flag.)*

Q25. What happens if a bug you introduce breaks production — free fix or billable? *(Correct: free fix within warranty period, usually 30 days.)*

Q26. Do you charge for meetings and status calls?

Section 5 — Availability & delivery

Q27. How many hours per week can you dedicate to Cravitoo?

Q28. Are you working with other clients simultaneously? *(Not necessarily bad — but be honest about it.)*

Q29. What's your typical response time to a P0 production issue at 11 PM?

Q30. What's your realistic estimate to ship the Mobile Play Store rebuild (Item #1 on my backlog)? *(Compare with your own gut. Wildly optimistic = red flag.)*

Q31. How do you handle vacation / sick days — will you have backup coverage?

Section 6 — Process & collaboration

Q32. How do you prefer to communicate — Slack, WhatsApp, email, GitHub Issues?

Q33. Will you write a daily or weekly status update?

Q34. How do you estimate work — story points, hours, gut feel?

Q35. Do you use a task tracker (Linear / Notion / GitHub Issues), or want me to set one up?

Q36. How do you handle scope changes? What if I ask for a feature mid-sprint?

Q37. What's your PR review process — do you self-review before requesting mine?

Q38. Do you push directly to `main`, or always work in branches with PRs? *(Correct: branches + PRs. Anyone who pushes to main directly is a hard pass.)*

Section 7 — Legal & handover

Q39. Will you sign an NDA before I share anything sensitive?

Q40. Are you comfortable with a "work-for-hire" agreement where all IP belongs to me?

Q41. Do you require a contract before starting, or will a Statement of Work do?

Q42. What happens to the code if we part ways — do you retain any copy? *(Correct answer: no, they wipe local copies and revoke access.)*

Q43. Will you document what you build so I'm not locked into you?

Section 8 — Soft signals to watch for

Q44. What questions do YOU have for me? *(A great developer will have 10+ questions. A bad one will just say "when do I start?")*

Q45. What's the last technical mistake you made in production and how did you handle it? *(Anyone who says "I don't make mistakes" is lying — walk away.)*

Q46. What's your favourite way to keep learning? *(Newsletters, GitHub, YouTube, courses — any answer is fine except "I don't need to.")*

Q47. Why are you interested in Cravitoo specifically vs any other project? *(If they can't articulate why beyond "money", their engagement will be shallow.)*

Red-flag summary — walk away if ANY of these happen

- They ask for 100% advance
- They can't show any live URL
- They push back on signing an NDA
- They refuse to work in branches / PRs
- They don't use 2FA
- They say "I've never made a mistake"
- They quote a suspiciously low OR suspiciously high price for the market
- They can't articulate a security concept in plain language
- They dismiss testing as unnecessary
- They want your master admin credentials on day one
- References go quiet or take days to respond
- They talk over you or dismiss your questions

Green flags — hire them if you see these

- Comes to Meeting 1 with 5+ questions of their own
 - Asks to see the code before committing to a rate
 - Volunteers to sign the NDA before you ask
 - Suggests starting with a paid trial task (1–2 days)
 - Has a public GitHub with recent commits
 - Comfortable saying "I don't know, let me check" instead of bluffing
 - Talks about tests, PR reviews, and CI without you bringing it up
 - Has a portfolio site or Calendly link (signs of a professional operation)
 - Suggests a fixed-scope trial for a specific bug fix first, then retainer
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The 10-minute rating card

After each meeting, score them 1–5 on these five dimensions. Anyone below 3 on any single line is a NO.

Dimension	Score (1–5)
Technical depth (React / Python / mobile)	
Security awareness	
Communication clarity	
Curiosity — asks good questions	
Trust — feels like they respect your time & money	

Total $\geq 20 / 25$ → hire on a small paid trial task **15–19 / 25** → get a second opinion, or move on **< 15 / 25** → next candidate